An Affine Semigroup from Orbifold Boundary Conditions: cut, phylogenetic and hierarchical models in the unit-weight sector, and weighted configurations beyond them (Part IX-B)

Combinatorial commutative algebra · affine semigroups and toric ideals

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At a glance

What the paper contributes

The equivalence classes of orbifold boundary conditions are the elements of an **affine semigroup**: one generator per label of the alphabet of Part IX-A, graded by weight, embedded by its local data at the fixed points. The note identifies that semigroup and decides which of its cases are complete intersections.

- **The dictionary** (unit-weight sector), as an equality of point configurations: the cut configurations of P_3, C_4 and the wheel W_4 (Sturmfels–Sullivant); group-based models on claw trees; a mixed-order variant not located in the literature; binary hierarchical models of cross-polytope boundaries.
- **Thirteen complete intersections** with explicit gluing trees (unitary, orthogonal and symplectic alphabets); seven are weighted, outside every framework of the dictionary.
- **The tripod, decided** (Proposition 1): the group-based model on the tripod is a complete intersection exactly when $|G| \leq 3$, for every finite abelian group.
- **Every $k \geq 3$** (Proposition 2): $(S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2)^k$ is not a complete intersection, by the extreme-ray bound of Fischer–Morris–Shapiro (Theorem 1, cited), and not a cut ideal, by a count of edges.
- **The exceptional case** $S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2 \times S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2$: not a complete intersection by an exhaustive sweep (Proposition 3); a unique minimal Markov basis of 8 + 8 indispensable binomials in two orbits under an automorphism group of order 128 (Proposition 4); Cohen–Macaulay type 9 (Proposition 5).
- **Inherited**, and said so in the Ledger: the gluing criterion and the extreme-ray bound, the cut-ring invariants of W_4 (normality, degree 64, codimension 7), the group-based codimensions.

🚀 **Start here: Proposition 1**: the group-based tripod is a complete intersection exactly when $|G| \leq 3$.

Main results:

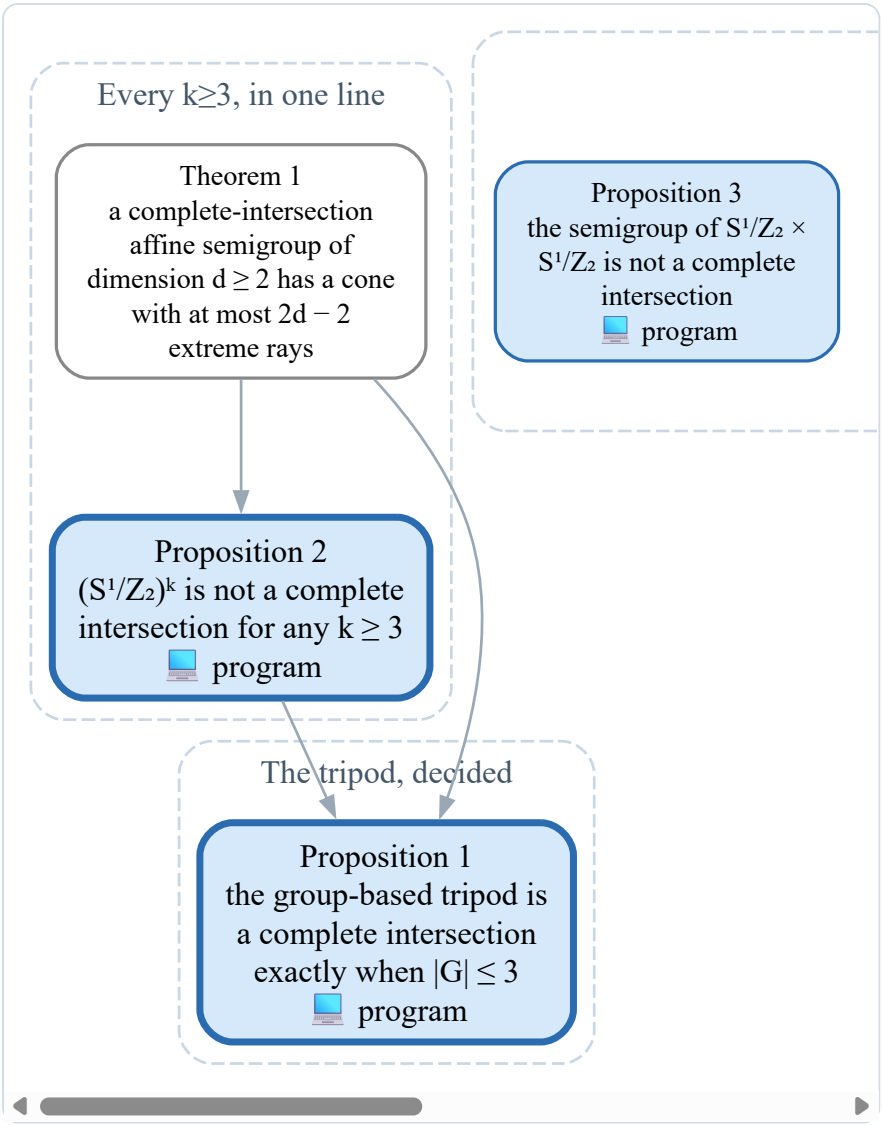
- **Proposition 1**: the group-based tripod is a complete intersection exactly when $|G| \leq 3$
- **Proposition 2**: $(S^1/Z_2)^k$ is not a complete intersection for any $k \geq 3$
- **Proposition 4**: unique minimal Markov basis: 8 quadrics + 8 quartics, all indispensable, two orbits under a group of order 128
- **Proposition 5**: Cohen–Macaulay type 9: canonical module generated in degrees 4 (one) and 6 (eight)

6 results | ✅ **0** formalized in Lean | ◐ **0** with a part in Lean

💻 **5** checked by a program | written proof only | (a result can carry several tags)

🗺️ Map of the results (click a box to go to it)

Dependencies in the written proof: an arrow A → B means that this proof of B uses A. Every result rests on its written proof; the tags record what was checked besides, and each statement's “Evidence & scope” block says how far. The colour of a box is its strongest tag, in the order above; the tags in the box give the rest. Boxes with a thick border are the main results; click a box to read the statement.



📐 Setting (copied from the paper, §1)

Let $L = \{\ell_1, \dots, \ell_n\}$ be the alphabet, $w_i \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$ the weight of ℓ_i and $v_i \in \mathbb{N}^c$ its local data. Put $a_i = (w_i, v_i) \in \mathbb{N}^{1+c}$ and let $S = \langle a_1, \dots, a_n \rangle \subseteq \mathbb{N}^{1+c}$ be the affine semigroup they generate. The number of equivalence classes of rank N is the number of elements of S in degree N, so the class-counting generating function is the Hilbert series $H(S, x)$. The lattice of relations $\mathcal{L} = \ker(\mathbb{Z}^n \to \mathbb{Z}^{1+c})$ has rank $n - \dim S$, and its elements are the moves preserving every local datum. *(§2)* On $(S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2)^k$ the ground set is the $2k$ reflections, in k antipodal pairs, and a fixed point is a choice of one reflection per circle. So the marginals are indexed by the 2^k *transversals*, which are the facets of the boundary complex of the k-dimensional cross-polytope: $n = 2^{2k} = 4^k$, $\dim S = \#\{\text{faces}\} = \sum_j \binom{k}{j} 2^j = 3^k$. *(§4)* For a partition $T = T_1 \sqcup T_2$ of the minimal generating set into non-empty parts, S is the *gluing* of $S_1 = \langle T_1 \rangle$ and $S_2 = \langle T_2 \rangle$ by α if $\alpha \in S_1 \cap S_2$, $\alpha \neq 0$, and $G(S_1) \cap G(S_2) = \mathbb{Z}\alpha$. Fischer, Morris and Shapiro prove that an affine semigroup which is not free is a complete intersection if and only if it is a gluing of two complete intersections. *(§5)* The smallest member of the group-based family is the claw tree with three leaves. The labels are the triples of group elements summing to zero, so $n = |G|^2$, and the local datum is the indicator of each entry.

5 The tripod, decided

Proposition 1. p. 6

> *Let G be a finite abelian group and let S be the semigroup of the group-based model on the tripod. Then S is a complete intersection if and only if $|G| \leq 3$: it is free for $|G| = 2$, a complete intersection with two cubics for $|G| = 3$, and not a complete intersection for $\mathbb{Z}_4$, for $\mathbb{Z}_2 \times \mathbb{Z}_2$, or for any abelian group of order at least 5.*

> NEW **Classical and new:** the paper looked for this classification in the group-based literature and did not find it; what that literature settles for the tripod is normality, and the local (Zariski-open) complete intersection of [CFM] (§4, §6, Ledger).

↳ Not used by another result of the paper.

Proof

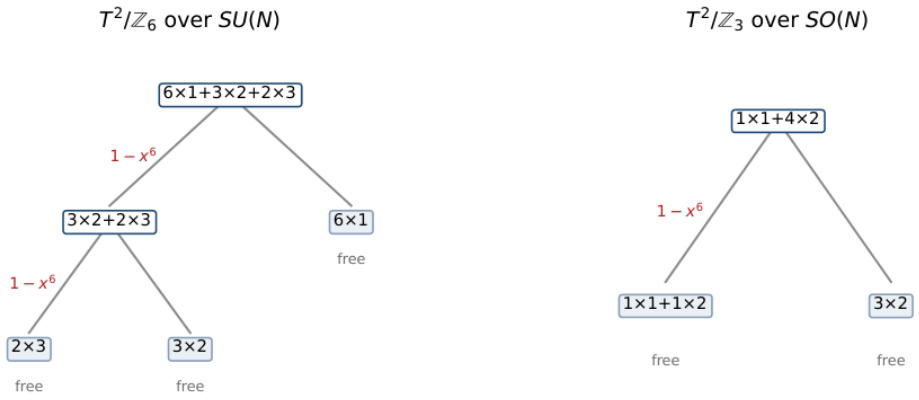
The labels are the triples of group elements summing to zero, so $n = |G|^2$, and the local datum is the indicator of each entry, so $\dim S = 3(|G| - 1) + 1 = 3|G| - 2$ and the codimension is $(|G| - 1)(|G| - 2)$, which is the value the phylogenetics literature prints for the tripod.

Every generator is an extreme ray, by the argument of Proposition 2: it is a $0/1$ vector with one 1 in each of three blocks, hence one of the vertices of a product of three simplices, and a vertex stays extreme in the hull of any subset containing it. Nothing in that argument uses the group law beyond the fact that the labels select a subset of those vertices, so it holds unchanged for every finite abelian G and not only for the cyclic ones — which is what lets the bound below be quantified over all of them. Theorem 1 therefore requires

$$\boxed{|G|^2 \;\leq\; 2\dim S - 2 \;=\; 6|G| - 6, \qquad \text{that is} \qquad |G|^2 - 6|G| + 6 \leq 0,} \tag{1}$$

which holds for $2 \leq |G| \leq 4$ and fails from 5 on: writing $f(g) = g^2 - 6g + 6$, one has $f(5) = 1 > 0$ and $f(g+1) - f(g) = 2g - 5 > 0$ for $g \geq 3$, so f is positive and increasing on the integers $g \geq 5$. The bound therefore settles every group of order five or more; the trivial group is outside its reach for the other reason, $\dim S = 1$ being below the $d \geq 2$ of Theorem 1, and its semigroup is $\mathbb{N}$, free. That leaves four groups open, of three orders: $\mathbb{Z}_2$, $\mathbb{Z}_3$, $\mathbb{Z}_4$ and $\mathbb{Z}_2 \times \mathbb{Z}_2$. Each of the four is decided by the gluing criterion, exhaustively — the two of order 4 over all $2^{15} - 1$ partitions of their sixteen generators — with the results of Table 3.

Figure 1



Two gluing trees, as the search returns them. Each node is a set of generators, written by its multiset of weights; each split is a gluing and contributes the factor on the branch to ??; each leaf is a free semigroup. Both trees shown are weighted cases, so both are outside the frameworks of §??.

Evidence & scope

- **Program:** Z_2, Z_3, Z_4, $Z_2 \times Z_2$ by the gluing criterion (the order-4 groups over all $2^{15}-1$ partitions), with the codimension control $(|G|-1)(|G|-2)$. `scripts/tripod_gate.py`, `outputs/tripod_gate.txt`
- **By hand:** every order ≥ 5 by the extreme-ray bound $|G|^2 \leq 6|G|-6$ of Theorem 1. `proof of Proposition 1`

8 Every $k \geq 3$, in one line

Theorem 1. **([8 , Cor. 3.4])** p. 9

> *Let S be a d-dimensional affine semigroup which is a complete intersection, with $d \geq 2$. Then the cone of S has at most $2d-2$ extreme rays.*

Classical and new: cited, not claimed: Fischer, Morris and Shapiro [FMS, Cor. 3.4].

↳ Used in: Proposition 1 (p. 4), Proposition 2 (p. 5)

Proposition 2. p. 9

> *For every $k \geq 3$, the semigroup of $(S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2)^k$ is not a complete intersection.*

Classical and new: claimed as the paper's own (Ledger), together with the edge count showing it is not a cut ideal for k ≥ 3; the bound it uses is Fischer–Morris–Shapiro [FMS, Cor. 3.4] (Theorem 1 of the paper, cited).

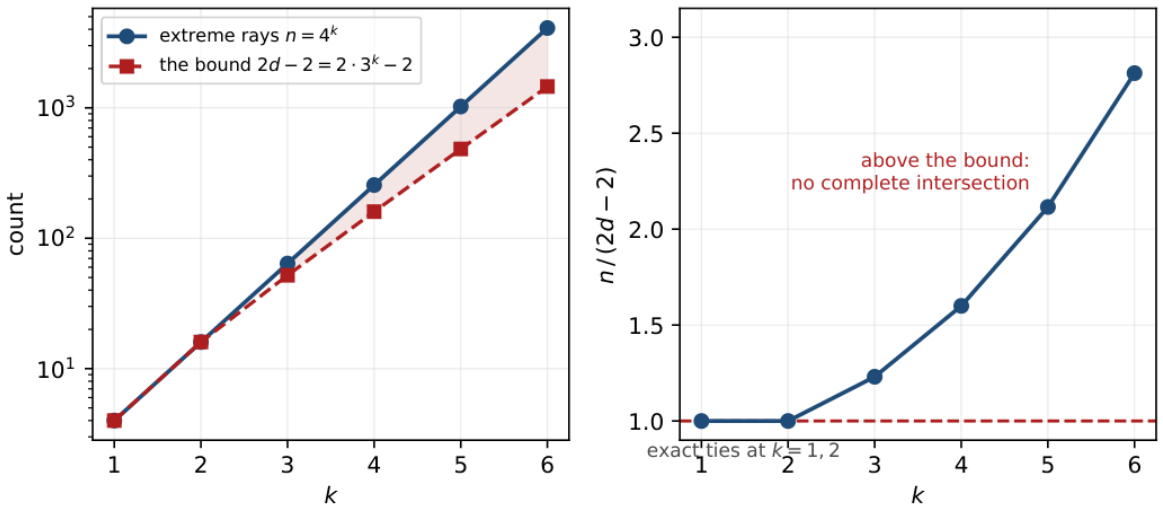
↳ Used in: Proposition 1 (p. 4)

Proof

> Every generator is an extreme ray. A generator is a $0/1$ vector with exactly one 1 in each of the 2^k fixed-point blocks, so the generators are *a subset of* the vertex set of the product of the fixed-point simplices — a proper subset, since the product orbifold

correlates the data at different fixed points and only 4^k of those vertices occur. That is enough: a vertex of a polytope remains extreme in the convex hull of any subset of the vertices containing it, and all the generators lie in one weight hyperplane, so each of them spans an extreme ray of the cone. With $n = 4^k$ and $d = 3^k$ from (2), Theorem 1 requires $4^k \leq 2 \cdot 3^k - 2$, and $(4/3)^3 > 2$.

Figure 2



Proposition 2, drawn: the extreme rays against the bound, and their ratio. The ratio is exactly 1 at $k = 1, 2$ — the bound is met, not approached — and exceeds 1 from $k = 3$. The ties are why $k = 2$ needed the exhaustive sweep, and why no inequality of this shape can separate a complete intersection from something meeting its bound exactly.

Evidence & scope

- **Program:** n = 4^k, d = 3^k, every generator extreme (integer Farkas certificates), k = 1..5; control: FMS Example 3.5 rebuilt for r = 1..4 attains 2d − 2 exactly, and two decoys. `scripts/fms_cone_gate.py`, `outputs/fms_cone_gate.txt`

9 The exception, exhaustively

Proposition 3. p. 10

The semigroup of $S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2 \times S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2$ is not a complete intersection.

NEW **Classical and new:** a direct argument independent of [SScuts, Table 1], which already records the cut ring of W_4 (8 + 8 minimal generators, codimension 7, degree 64) (§3, §8).

↳ Not used by another result of the paper.

Proof

It is not free: its relation lattice has rank 7. By [8] it is then a complete intersection if and only if some partition of its minimal generating set into two non-empty parts is a gluing. There are $2^{15} - 1 = 32767$ such partitions; testing each exactly, 16 survive the rank condition on the lattice intersection and none of those has an admissible α.

Evidence & scope

- **Program:** all 32767 partitions of the 16 labels: 16 survive the rank condition, none has an admissible gluing element. `scripts/gluing_tree.py`, `outputs/gluing_tree.txt`
- **Program:** minimal Markov basis 8 + 8 against a relation lattice of rank 7. `scripts/complete_intersection.py`, `outputs/complete_intersection.txt`
- **Literature:** the same invariants in Sturmfels–Sullivant, Table 1 (row of the suspension of C_4). [SScuts]

Proposition 4. p. 11

On $S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2 \times S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2$ at rank 4, exactly eight fibres of the local-datum map are not connected by the degree-2 relations. Each of those fibres contains exactly two boundary conditions, and they are the only fibres of rank 4 with more than one component. The corresponding eight quartic binomials are therefore indispensable: each occurs, up to sign, in every Markov basis of the ideal. So are the eight quadrics, for the same reason at rank 2; hence

the toric ideal has a \emph{unique} minimal binomial generating set, up to signs:

$$8 \text{ quadrics } + \text{ } 8 \text{ quartics.}$$

Under $\mathcal{G}$ the sixteen fall into exactly two orbits, one per degree.

NEW **Classical and new:** claimed as the paper's own (Ledger): uniqueness up to signs and the two orbits under Aut(A); the 8 + 8 count itself is in [SScuts, Table 1].

↳ Not used by another result of the paper.

Evidence & scope

- **Program:** the eight split fibres at rank 4 and the eight degree-4 generators are the same eight. `scripts/quartic_orbit_gate.py`, `outputs/quartic_orbit_gate.txt`
- **Program:** all sixteen indispensable; Aut(A) computed directly has order 128 and equals the group of seven involutions; orbits 8 + 8 (and the 8 canonical generators one orbit). `scripts/indispensable_gate.py`, `outputs/indispensable_gate.txt`

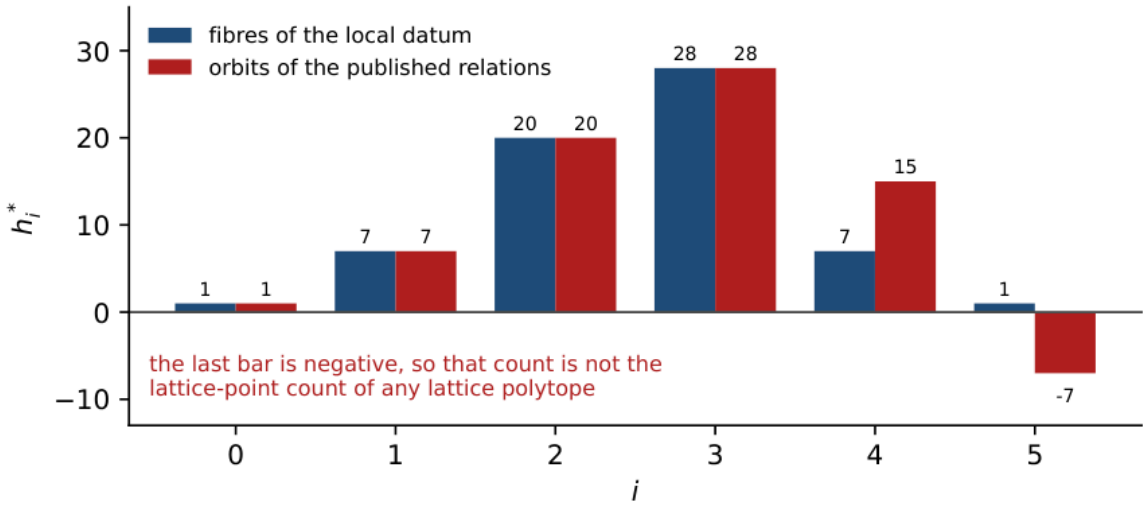
Proposition 5. p. 12

The semigroup ring of $S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2 \times S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2$ has Cohen–Macaulay type 9. Its canonical module has one minimal generator in degree $4 = \operatorname{codeg} P$ and eight in degree 6, and none in any other degree.

NEW **Classical and new:** claimed as the paper's own: the type 9 and the degrees of the canonical generators; normality, Cohen–Macaulayness and non-Gorensteinness are [SScuts, Table 1] (Ledger).

↳ Not used by another result of the paper.

Figure 3



The two counts of $S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2 \times S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2$ written over $(1-x)^9$. The first four coefficients agree; the last is negative on the right, and a lattice polytope cannot produce a negative h_i^*. The two series are $1, 16, 128, 688, \mathbf{2809}$ and $1, 16, 128, 688, \mathbf{2817}$.

Evidence & scope

- **Program:** interior points 1, 16, 136, 752, 3097 in degrees 4–8 by enumeration and by $(-1)^d H(1/x)$; minimal generators 1, 0, 8, 0, 0; Gorenstein decoy S^1/Z_2 returns type 1. `scripts/gorenstein_gate.py`, `outputs/gorenstein_gate.txt`
- **Program:** h*-vector (1,7,20,28,7,1) and the degree-2-moves series (1,7,20,28,15,−7). `scripts/formula_atlas.py`, `outputs/formula_atlas.txt`

Tables cited

hdrblue white$G$	white $n = \lvert G\rvert^2$	white $\dim S$	whitecodim	white $2\dim S - 2$	whiteverdict
$\mathbb{Z}_2$	4	4	0	6	free
softgrey $\mathbb{Z}_3$	9	7	2	12	complete intersection, degrees $[3, 3]$
$\mathbb{Z}_4$	16	10	6	18	not a complete intersection (swept)
softgrey $\mathbb{Z}_2 \times \mathbb{Z}_2$	16	10	6	18	not a complete intersection (swept)
$\lvert G\rvert \geq 5$	$\lvert G\rvert^2$	$3\lvert G\rvert - 2$	—	$6\lvert G\rvert - 6$	not a complete intersection ((4))

Table 3: The tripod, for every finite abelian group. The codimension is computed from the generator matrix and agrees with $(\lvert G\rvert - 1)(\lvert G\rvert - 2)$, which is a control that could have failed. The bound is silent exactly on the four

small groups, which is why they are swept; and $\mathbb{Z}_2 \times \mathbb{Z}_2$ is the group of the Kimura 3-parameter model.

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